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Implementation Plan – Karnataka National Education Policy 2020

by

Task Force for Implementation of NEP 2020 in Karnataka

SUMMARY

November 2020

I. Approach and Methodology adopted by the Taskforce

The Task Force was constituted by the Government of Karnataka on March 4, 2020. The Task Force further constituted two Sub-Committees on two critical components of the Policy: Curriculum Reform in Higher Education and Transforming Governance and Regulation in Higher Education. For School Education, the points from the multiple discussions at Samagra Shikshana with various stakeholders, as well as the work by the chapter-wise sub-groups that were set up, have been used to evolve the implementation plan.

1. **Principle:** The Plan lays out actions based on critical aspects such as - legislative action, structural transformation, administrative changes and curricular reform; financial implications are not addressed in this document, further phases of implementation will be developed via consultative process.
2. **Prioritization:** Mainly actions pertaining to 'year 0' (2020-2021) which can be done without financial implications and requiring legislative action.
3. **Critical Engagement:** It is crucial that all Higher Education Institutions have a complete ownership of all actions and autonomy is provided even at the school level as per the policy provisions. Implementation will be successful only if all stakeholders are included and take ownership of their actions. Preparation of staff also necessary.

II. Education in Karnataka – The existing base

Karnataka is the Educational Hub of the country. It has many renowned School and Higher Education Institutions. More importantly there have been several initiatives taken in the State which align to the foundational principles of National Education Policy 2020 (NEP 2020).

- **Multi-lingual Environment** and a child friendly activity-based pedagogy as part of the Nali Kali initiative.
- **Nutrition for Children** is enhanced by the Ksheera Bhagya scheme of providing milk to children on a daily basis.
- **Early Years Learning** has been launched in 276 Karnataka Public Schools (KPS) with a maximum enrolment of 30 students in each section.
- **Karnataka Public Schools (KPSs)** are K-12 Public Schools that have been established across the State.
- **Teacher Professional Development (TPD)** is choice based and self-paced under the Guru Chetna model which has more than 100 modules of different durations to choose from.
- **State Higher Education Council** is present in Karnataka.
- **The Karnataka State Innovative Universities Bill, 2011** sought to restructure and establish Innovative Universities by providing more autonomy in the academic sphere.

- **Karnataka Higher Education Academy (KHEA)** at Dharwad was established to help improve the overall performance of Colleges and Universities in Karnataka State.
- **Inclusive Education Initiatives** such as the creation of Kalyan Karnataka region development Board (KKRDB) to improve the region are revolutionary and is closely aligned to NEP 2020 principles.

III. Proposed Structure of Education in Karnataka

Karnataka Shikshana Aayog

Coordination and alignment across a range of departments, functions, bodies and entities is essential. Thus, there is the need for creating an overarching body that will integrate the multiple efforts that will be in progress in widely diverse institutions and departments of the Government of Karnataka. Task Force suggests creating a Karnataka Shikshana Aayog (KSA)/Karnataka Education Commission (KEC). The CM should chair this body, and should convene a meeting at least twice a year, or as often as is deemed necessary, to review the progress of education in the State in its totality, and to appropriately empower and motivate the KSA/KEC as needed through his/her authority. The State Higher Education Minister as well as the School Education Minister should be the Vice Chairpersons of the KSA/SEC.

School Education Structure

The structure that is proposed for the governance and regulation of School Education ensures separation of powers and no overlapping jurisdiction between the different agencies entrusted with School Education. In the proposed structure, independent bodies will administer schools, regulate schools, decide on academic aspects and conduct assessments respectively. This separation of power will be ensured by a council that should be established – The Karnataka State Education Council (KSEC).

Higher Education Structure

The Task Force decided to mirror the structure NEP 2020 proposes to govern and regulate Higher Education. The Karnataka Higher Education Commission (KHEC) will be the body with an oversight on the independent and autonomous bodies that will govern and regulate the Higher Education space; viz the Karnataka Higher Education Grants Council (KHEGS), the Karnataka Higher Education Regulatory Council (KHERC) and the Karnataka Research and Innovation Council (KRIC). The National Accreditation Council (NAC) at the Centre will by itself establish adequate Accreditation Institutions (AIs) in the in.

IV. Proposed plan for School Education in Karnataka

Separation of regulation and operations of schools

The Karnataka School Education Council (KSEC) should oversee all aspects at a macro level and co-ordinate between various agencies and liaison between the various departments and bodies connected to School Education and the Government. It should put together a task force which will work on how to significantly increase public funding for School Education. Another new body called the SSSA has to be established as the regulatory unit for education.

"Light but tight" regulatory principles based on the School Quality Assessment and Accreditation Framework (SQAAF) which the DSERT would develop in consultation with relevant stakeholders to be used. The roles of the other bodies within the School Education department should be re-defined and ensured that they do not have overlapping jurisdiction or conflict of interest.

Restructuring School Education

Curricular reforms should drive the transformation of the current structure of schooling to 5+3+3+4 (Foundational, Preparatory, Middle and Secondary Stage). On one end, the focus should be on integrating XI and XII into the secondary stage, while on the other, a 'Foundation years' wing' needs to begin work on the 5-year integrated curriculum. The Department of State Educational Research and Training (DSERT) will have to revise curriculum – particularly on Foundational and Preparatory stage and reduce the existing curriculum load.

Inclusion of early childhood education in School Education

A State level co-ordination unit should be established, led by a Principal Secretary level officer who will ensure all meetings across Women and Child Department and Education Department take place in order to establish appropriate roles and responsibilities of the two departments. As a first step, students between 0 to 3 and 3 to 8 years will be mapped across the State along with number of teachers serving them. The next step will be aligning the curriculum to the new structure and ensuring total alignment to the NEP 2020 principles. In this regard a sub-committee should be established to work out the revision of Nali Kali curriculum and separation of Nali Kali grades 1-2 and grade 3. Also, a detailed guidelines should be issued that all early years' education across the State will be based on the 'Chili Pili Plus' curriculum.

Attainment of foundational literacy and numeracy

A Foundational Literacy and Numeracy Wing should be set up which can be re-converted to the State Mission on the model expected at the Centre. Among its first tasks could be to map the State on the current learning status regarding basic literacy and numeracy using existing data; and specifically identify disadvantaged areas based on children's performance in grades III to V. Action plans should be based on this baseline.

Equitable and inclusive education

Government of Karnataka should initiate Gender Inclusion Funding and Disability Funding as two special components to address inclusivity related aspects in education. And, on the other hand to further address the issue, the State should focus on establishing adequate number of SEZs; the Eligibility Enrolment Ratio (EER) could be a determinant. Finally, all scholarships should be consolidated and provided for the students on a single platform. These measures will enable an equitable and inclusive education system.

School complexes (SC)/clusters for effective governance and optimal resourcing

Schools established as part of special initiatives such as the KPS, Adarsha Vidyalya, Moraji Schools should be brought under one head; and these schools based on their respective context should be identified and converted into School Complexes. This is an area into which Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funds could also be channeled. The Task Force also suggests the development of guidelines for private aided and unaided schools to start their own networks of schools such that schools benefit from each other.

Curricular, pedagogical and assessment reforms

DSERT to lead the curricular and pedagogic revision based on the principles advocated by NEP 2020; the different wings to be established within DSERT to take on the responsibility for their stages. Concerted efforts should be made to bring synergy in curriculum between all stages of School Education i.e., ECCE, Primary and secondary levels and Higher Education.

The Karnataka School Education Examination Board (KSEEB) should be engaged in the activities in order to gain exposure and begin working on assessment reforms and pilot assessments and make suggestions to PARAKH. Karnataka Open School should be strengthened as an alternative Board.

Teacher recruitment, service conditions and career progression

The focus should be on strengthening the existing teacher professional development model called Guru Chetna to make it the exclusive platform for all continuous professional development (CPD) within school education; it will be a choice-based and self-paced CPD for teachers by integrating technology such that teachers are least inconvenienced to attend these developmental programmes. CPD could also be opened up for teachers in private schools and educators from civil society organizations with a minimum fee.

Change in service rules should be brought about to ensure vertical growth within the different stages of School Education so that no teacher has to move to different stages for a career growth. It should also provide for the lateral movement across stages if one desires. Voluntary selection of school complexes by teachers followed by changes

in recruitment in order to ensure recruitments take place only to the identified school complexes is another important change to be ushered in.

V. Proposed plan on Higher Education in Karnataka

Structure for Higher Education Regulation in Karnataka

The new HEI governance and regulation structure should be created through appropriate legislation. This legislation in the form of a new Act – Karnataka Universities (KSU) Act – should be an overarching legislation to provide for the constitution, appointment, modalities of functioning, rules and regulations, and the roles and responsibilities of the independent and autonomous bodies – KHEC, KHEGC, KHERC and KRIC. The proposed KSU Act while making provision for creating this structure, should focus on the concept of Universities, independent BOG, strengthening of affiliated colleges, graded autonomy to them, importance to Institutional Development Plan (IDP), innovation and flexibility to Universities, removal of geographical restrictions for admission, enabling mechanism for new academic architecture etc as per the NEP 2020. In addition, cconstitution and composition of BoG, powers and Functions of BoG, compliance system – disclosure, reporting, cross-checking should also be part of the Act with complete clarity that the HEIs will have the full autonomy to establish their respective BoGs without any interference from any external agency.

Though the ordinance route would help in quickly putting into place the required processes, it is important that a legislation is also in place in this regard.

The proposed structure requires detailing out the composition of the new independent and autonomous bodies and the selection of the Chair and Vice Chair of the independent boards. Preparation of a blueprint of the proposed structure for regulation and soliciting suggestions of stakeholders on the operative parts will be the next key steps.

The Government should enable adequate number of Type 1: Research-intensive Universities (RIUs) and Type 2: Teaching-intensive Universities (TIUs) by identifying existing Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in the State which can be classified into the three types. Ensuring that the HEIs are spread across the State and the SEZs are part of the planning is crucial.

Governance of Universities and Colleges in Karnataka

Institutional Development Plan (IDP) is an important governance related activity for all HEIs. The IDPs will form the basis of the graded accreditation (GA) of HEIs with concomitant graded autonomy. This phase wise empowerment of HEIs is the path towards complete autonomy as suggested by the NEP 2020. The scheme for graded empowerment of affiliated Colleges should be developed in consultation with Universities, teacher associations and NGOs. Most Colleges and their BoGs will require support for accreditation. The college BoGs that take efforts to move towards becoming multi-disciplinary and large scale and take adequate steps towards autonomy should

be incentivized. KHEC should take charge of this entire transition; it should start a Mission on College Empowerment.

Curriculum framework for transition into holistic under-graduate program

A broad curriculum framework for the four-year under-graduate program should be developed under the leadership of KHEC; the standards and graduate attributes will come from the independent body focusing on curriculum at the Centre. Comprehensive survey of students' aspirations should be explored in order to understand the student community needs. Broad consensus on curricular reforms in Universities could be arrived at the State level based on NEP (based on present UGC regulations). A Mission on Curricular Reforms should be established to carry out the required changes.

Development of Research and Innovation in HE of Karnataka

Government of Karnataka and the Higher Education Department officials should bring together a group of eminent academics, researchers and educationists along with the Task Force members to ensure that, the bill to be drafted for the new legislation (KSU Act), adequately captures the requirement of research in the State. The objectives for KRIC should be drawn keeping in mind the overall objective to seed, grow, and facilitate research at all HEIs, particularly those where research is at a nascent stage, through mechanisms of mentoring that will be institutionalized. A big focus should be to grow an ecosystem for research at institutions where it currently does not exist or is limited; there are already a few high-quality research institutions which should be roped in to become mentors or lead institutions in this regard by providing them the required incentives. Government of Karnataka should meet this objective by setting aside a large enough corpus; this should include consolidation of funds across various Departments.

Faculty development in Universities and Colleges

The responsibilities of faculty development could be divided amongst the current agencies such as KSHEC, KHEA, Commissioner of Collegiate Education and the HRD Centers of Universities. KHEA must play a significant role as one of the key objectives of the Academy is to build capacity among the faculty, particularly the new recruits. KHEC should prioritize its study and evolve best practices in faculty development; it could prepare a blue print for faculty development for the next 3 to 5 years and evolve guidelines for BoGs with regard to faculty recruitment, career progression and compensation management (faculty development related aspects will be part of every IDP of all mentor and pilot HEIs).

Interventions on equity and inclusiveness in HE in Karnataka

Government of Karnataka along with KHEC should focus on establishing adequate number of SEZs; the Eligibility Enrolment Ratio (EER) could be a determinant. It should consolidate scholarships as well as launch more. Increased financial assistance

for students should be the overall objective. Imperative to launch one platform for all kinds of scholarships that are available from different departments; this will ensure that access becomes easy and universal. KHEC should maintain databases which will include all relevant information, and this should be linked to the Digital India Program. CSR funds should be used / directed toward addressing the equity issue. KHEC and KHERC should provide guidelines to BoGs on how IDP should include aspects related to inclusion; as indicated in the policy it will be part of the assessment and accreditation of the HEIs as part of the regulatory protocol. The goal should be to eliminate all forms of exclusionary practices within the higher education domain.

VI. Implementation of NEP 2020 in Karnataka – Key tasks

1. To establish an Implementation Mission with specific targets that are mapped on a quarterly calendar for the next 3 years and a public review of implementation in every quarter; constitute an Implementation Task Force (ITF)
2. There should be an immediate provision made for 'implementation fund' in SSK (Samagra Shikshana) and Karnataka State Higher Education Council (KSHEC).
3. Establish the regulatory bodies – the State School Standards Authority (SSSA) and the Karnataka Higher Education Regulatory Council (KHERC).
4. The new KSU Act for establishing the proposed Higher Education structure.
5. Separation of powers within the existing bodies in the education department.
6. Amendments to service rules – tenure-ships in KPS/School Complexes; delineate teacher career progression and ensure vertical career progression
7. Establish Special Education Zones (SEZs) across identified sections within the State.
8. Establish gender and disability funds along with other inclusive education measures for students from socio-economically disadvantaged groups (SEDGs)

School Education specific

1. Establish the Foundational Years' Wing and the Literacy and Numeracy Wing.
2. Curriculum and pedagogic revisions to be undertaken by DSERT for Foundational and Preparatory stages of schooling; the middle and secondary stage to be taken up after NCF 2021 is released.
3. Identify successful schools, particularly the KPS and other special schools, and build them into School Complex Centers.
4. Strengthen Guru Chetna further and make it the exclusive teacher professional development platform in the State.

Higher Education specific

1. Establish BoGs within the HEIs; initial handholding from KSHEC which can focus on mentor institutions at first so that they can become mentors and hand hold other HEIs.
2. Mentor institutions to be identified and workshops conducted to ensure alignment with Policy principles.
3. IDPs to be developed by all HEIs; initial handholding from KSHEC and mentor institutions.

VII. Conclusion and Way Forward

The Implementation Plan does not contain all the details required to implement the entire policy. These details should evolve through a consultative process with all stakeholders of education.

The detailed plan should focus on a phased implementation with a detailed quarterly planning for each of the phases:

- Phase 1 - targets for 2023; beginning with 2020 as 'year 0'
- Phase 2 - targets for 2025
- Phase 3 - Targets for the next 10 years i.e.2030

Action points could be prioritized based on what is most critical and can be done without financial implications, such as those requiring legislative action.

The Implementation Task Force (ITF) established by Government of Karnataka will ensure the continuity of the implementation.

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